## Copilot

Yes, that's correct. When you expect a result from a recursive function in Java, you need to either:

- Use the `return` keyword to directly return the result of the recursive call.
- Perform an operation with the result of the recursive call and then return it.
- Assign the result of the recursive call to a variable and then return that variable.

This ensures that each recursive call contributes to the final result, which is then passed back up through the call stack to the initial caller. Without doing this, the results of the recursive calls would not be captured, and the final result would be incorrect or incomplete.

Here's a quick example to illustrate using an operation with the recursive call:

```
public class RecursiveSum {

    static int sum(int n) {
        // Base case
        if (n <= 1) {
            return n;
        }

        // Recursive case with an operation
        int partialSum = n + sum(n - 1);
        return partialSum;
    }

    public static void main(String[] args) {
        int total = sum(5);
        System.out.println("Total sum is: " + total);
    }
}
```

In this code:

- The `sum` method calculates the sum of all numbers from `n` down to 1.
- The base case returns `n` itself when `n` is less than or equal to 1.
- The recursive case performs an addition operation with `n` and the result of `sum(n - 1)`, assigns it to `partialSum`, and then returns `partialSum`.
- This way, each level of recursion adds its own value of `n` to the sum calculated by all deeper levels of recursion.